THOMPSON RIVERS UNIVERSITY

SENG 4620 - Practical Cloud Computing

Group Contract Guidelines

This document contains guidelines and clauses that your group may wish to use to form a group contract for your SENG 4620 Term Project. Do not copy this document exactly. It is a guideline. Your group should make their own and tailor it to what you agree will work best for your team.

The success of the group will depend on the cooperation and professionalism of its members. Employers will expect you to know how to work effectively in groups: how to determine what needs to be done; how to find information; how to assess information; how to share the workload; and how to resolve interpersonal conflicts that might arise. Effective collaboration includes, but is not limited to:

- Participating fully (in spirit and actuality)
- Participating professionally (i.e., civil discourse; abiding by the rules of academic honesty)
  Meeting responsibilities (i.e., completing assigned tasks on time and to the best of your ability)
- Taking the consequences of not abiding by the group's rules.
  Giving group members appropriate credit where due
- Not giving credit where it isn't due

After reading through this document, select some or all of the rules you would like to implement as a group, and add any other that you feel would be beneficial. If you disagree with these rules, then as a group, amend them. It is important to set mutually agreed upon ground rules for contribution. For example, if you miss a meeting you could be expected to read and respond to notes taken at the meeting within 24 hours. Or, if you consistently miss meetings/fail to communicate/produce work, you will no longer be a part of the project group and will be expected to complete the group project on your own. (The instructor must be informed of this). That being said, life happens. Put yourself in the shoes of your group members. Try and understand where they are coming from and be inclusive as much as possible.

1. Each group member agrees to show up to class and to outside group meetings on time.

   Initials:

2. In the event that a group member is less than five minutes late, s/he may *quietly* join the group without disrupting it to ask what s/he missed. It is optional for the group members to fill in the late-comer.

   Initials:

3. Group members who are avoidably late must: [write out a consequence for being late.]

Initials:

4. A group member who is absent more than_____times will be dismissed from the group.

   Initials:

5. If a member submits plagiarized material and/or cheats, the group agrees to bring this to the instructor's attention immediately.

   Initials:

6. Each member agrees to familiarize him- or her- self with and abide by TRU's rules for Academic Honesty (available on the course Moodle site).

   Initials:

7. Members agree to treat one another with respect. Respect includes no name-calling. If you don't like an idea, address the idea, not the person (for example, "I don't think that idea will work because…" not "That's stupid"). In the event that a group member treats someone inappropriately, s/he will [write a consequence]:

   Initials:

8. No "cross talking" is allowed. This means not interrupting when someone else is talking.

   Initials:

9. In the event that a group member or members are dominating the group, it's the time keeper's job (or whoever you have assigned to this role) to politely interrupt them (this is when you *can* interrupt) and ask that someone else speak.

   Initials:

10. Other rules that the group would like to add:

Each member print name & then sign: Date:_____

Print Name: Signature:

Print Name: Signature:

Print Name: Signature:

References:

Sample Group Contract (2021). Teaching, Learning & Technology Center/Division of Undergraduate Education, UC Irvine. https://cns.utexas.edu/images/CNS/TIDES/teaching-portal/Examplegroupcontract.pdf (Accessed: 12 April 2021).

Working Effectively in Groups (2021). Learning Services, University of Waterloo. Available at: https://uwaterloo.ca/student-success/sites/ca.student-success/files/uploads/files/TipSheet_GroupWork_0.pdf (Accessed: 12 April 2021).